

Habitat 67

A revolutionary housing scheme built from prefabricated concrete modules to celebrate Canada's centennial



This extraordinary housing complex beside the banks of the St. Lawrence River in Montreal, Canada, began life as a master's thesis by the Israeli-Canadian architect Moshe Safdie (1938–). Safdie's academic advisor at McGill University later asked him to develop his plans for the forthcoming Expo 67, the world's fair being held to celebrate Canada's centennial as an independent nation.

Linked modules

Habitat 67 reaches up to 12 stories in height. It consists of 354 identical prefabricated concrete boxes arranged in various combinations to make 146 residences, each made up of one to eight linked boxes. The initial models of the project were built using LEGO® bricks in order to visualize how the finished building would look in three dimensions. Originally built as low-cost housing, Habitat has become a highly desirable residence. However, it failed to give rise to similar prefabricated buildings elsewhere, as its designer originally intended, nor did it revolutionize affordable housing for the masses.

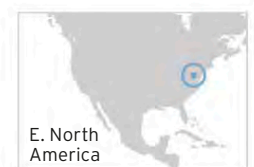
▷ LITTLE BOXES

Concrete boxes are stacked in such a way that each box is a step back from its immediate neighbor. This allows each apartment a terrace of its own, as well as excellent ventilation.



Vietnam Veterans Memorial

A somber memorial to those Americans who gave their lives in the Vietnam War



History records that 58,320 men and women died serving with the US armed forces in the Vietnam War, which lasted from 1955 to 1975. For some years, they went unremembered, but in 1982, a new memorial was opened in Constitution Gardens, next to the National Mall in Washington, D.C.

A wall, a memorial, a statue

The memorial consists of two 247-ft- (75-m-) long, highly polished, black granite walls inscribed with the names of the dead in horizontal rows on 142 panels. Close to the wall is a memorial to the women who served in the war, most of them as nurses. There is also a bronze statue named the Three Soldiers, which includes the first representation of an African American on the National Mall. Together they form a poignant memorial to one of the US's lengthiest and most wasteful wars.



◁ WALL OF REMEMBRANCE

Designed by Maya Lin, the wall lists all those service members who were killed in action or otherwise declared dead, as well as those whose status is unknown and who went missing in action. Only their names are recorded, without rank, unit, or decorations.